substantially, from $400 million in 1957 to $822 million in 1960, in addition to a four-year food deal worth $1.276 billion. The US also footed half the bill for the Indus rivers projects that were agreed with Pakistan under the aegis of the World Bank.[9] As relations with Washington warmed, Eisenhower made the first US presidential visit to India in December 1959, just months after the Longju incident.

While the Soviets briefly turned pro-China during the 1962 war, the US almost as briefly turned into India's military partner. Late in October, during the fighting with China, Washington endorsed India's view on the McMahon Line as the legitimate border in the eastern sector.[10] When India found itself in trouble in the war, it urgently requested military aid. The US and the UK responded by flying in arms and ammunition and carrying out supply missions from Calcutta to India's airbases near the front. In the second phase of the Chinese offensive in November, Delhi dramatically (and secretly) requested air transport. More importantly, Nehru asked for direct US involvement in providing radar facilities and defending Indian cities while the Indian Air Force attacked Chinese communications and supply lines. He also urgently asked the US to make available two squadrons of B-47 aircraft to be manned by the Indian Air Force which would carry out bombing-runs into Tibet.[11]

In the event, the US decided on a more moderate response – increasing supplies and transport as also sending the USS *Enterprise* aircraft carrier towards the region (the same carrier that in 1971 would be sent *against* India in the Bangladesh war). Before the US could become more directly involved, China halted offensive operations. Bruce Riedel, a former CIA officer, in his book on the US's role in the 1962 war, concludes that if hostilities had continued, Kennedy would have responded to 'Nehru's desperate appeal for Americans to start flying combat missions to fight the Chinese and defend India . . . Almost certainly Kennedy would have responded positively . . . we can be reasonably certain that America, India, and probably Great Britain would have been at war together against China.'[12]